



In the **IT industry**, the roles of **Solutions Architect**, **Solutions Consultant**, **Technical Consultant**, and **Functional Consultant** are distinct but complementary.

Each plays a critical part in ensuring that technology solutions are well-designed, implemented, and aligned with business needs. The consultant/architect roles in **Software Project Management** — with their **role, responsibilities, and skills** clearly outlined:



Solutions Architect

A professional who designs the overall technical structure of IT systems, ensuring they are scalable, secure, and aligned with business goals.

Role: Designs the overall technical architecture of IT solutions, ensuring scalability, security, and alignment with business needs.

Responsibilities:

- Define system architecture and integration points.
- Select appropriate technologies and platforms.
- Ensure compliance with performance, security, and scalability requirements.
- Collaborate with stakeholders to align technical design with business goals.

Skills:

- Cloud platforms (AWS, Azure, GCP).
- Enterprise architecture frameworks (TOGAF, Zachman).
- Strong knowledge of APIs, microservices, and DevOps.
- Communication and stakeholder management.



Solutions Consultant

A client-facing expert who **advises organizations on the best solution fit**, helping translate business needs into practical technology options.

Role: Acts as a bridge between the client and technical teams, focusing on **solution fit and business value**.

Responsibilities:

- Gather client requirements and propose tailored solutions.
- Demonstrate product capabilities and conduct workshops.
- Support pre-sales activities and proof-of-concepts.
- Ensure solutions meet business and functional needs.

Skills:

- Business analysis and requirement elicitation.
- Strong presentation and demo skills.
- Knowledge of enterprise software (ERP, CRM, BI tools).
- Customer engagement and relationship management.



Technical Consultant

A specialist who provides **hands-on technical expertise** in configuring, customizing, and integrating IT solutions.

Role: Provides **hands-on technical expertise** in implementing and customizing solutions.

Responsibilities:

- Configure, customize, and integrate software systems.



- Troubleshoot technical issues and optimize performance.
- Provide technical training and documentation.
- Collaborate with developers and architects on solution delivery.

Skills:

- Programming languages (Java, Python, C#, etc.).
- Database management (SQL, NoSQL).
- System integration and API development.
- Problem-solving and debugging.



Functional Consultant

A domain expert who ensures IT solutions **align with business processes and workflows**, focusing on functional accuracy.

Role: Focuses on **business processes and functional requirements**, ensuring the solution supports workflows effectively.

Responsibilities:

- Map business processes to system functionality.
- Define functional specifications and test cases.
- Conduct user training and support UAT (User Acceptance Testing).
- Act as liaison between business users and technical teams.

Skills:

- Deep knowledge of domain processes (finance, HR, supply chain, etc.).
- Requirement documentation (BRD, FRD, use cases).
- Testing and validation techniques.
- Strong communication and stakeholder collaboration.



Comparison Table



<u>Role</u>	<u>Focus</u>	<u>Responsibilities</u>	<u>Key Skills</u>
Solutions Architect	Technical design	Define architecture, select tech, ensure scalability	Cloud, APIs, DevOps, frameworks
Solutions Consultant	Business fit	Gather requirements, demos, pre-sales	Business analysis, ERP/CRM, client engagement
Technical Consultant	Implementation	Configure, customize, troubleshoot	Programming, databases, integration
Functional Consultant	Business processes	Map workflows, define specs, UAT	Domain expertise, documentation, testing

— Think of these roles as **layers of expertise**:

- **Solutions Architect** → designs the *blueprint*.
- **Solutions Consultant** → ensures the *solution fits business needs*.
- **Technical Consultant** → builds and configures the *technical solution*.
- **Functional Consultant** → validates the *business process alignment*.